Sample Question Paper

English Language and Literature

Class: X

Time allowed: 3 hours Maximum Marks: 80

Name: …… Roll No.: ……

General Instructions:

1. This question paper contains three sections: A, B and C.
2. All questions are compulsory, except where an internal choice is given.
3. Marks are indicated against each question.
4. Keep to the word limit wherever one is stated.

Section A – Reading (20 marks)

Read the passages given below and answer the questions that follow each passage.

When Meera Kulkarni moved into her fourth-floor flat in Pune, the first thing she missed was the sparrows. In the old house where she had grown up, the birds had been everywhere: on the window ledges, under the eaves, and in the courtyard, where her grandmother scattered grain every morning. In the new housing society, the balconies were neat, the lawns were trimmed, and no bird seemed to live there at all. Meera decided to act. She hung a small earthen bowl of water on her balcony rail and filled a feeder with millet. For three weeks, nothing came. Then, one October morning, she heard a thin, familiar chirp. A single sparrow sat on the rail, tilting its head at the feeder. By the end of the month there were six, and by winter the balcony had become, in her neighbours' words, a small station for birds. Other residents began to copy her. The society's garden committee set aside one wild corner of the grounds where grass was allowed to grow tall and go to seed. A local bird group counted forty-one sparrows in the society that spring, where a year earlier there had been none.

Q1. What did Meera miss most when she moved into the new flat? (1 mark)

(a) The courtyard of her old house
(b) The sound of sparrows
(c) Her grandmother's cooking
(d) The view from her window

Q2. What did Meera place on her balcony rail? (1 mark)

(a) A nest box and a swing
(b) A bowl of water and a feeder with millet
(c) A pot of flowering plants
(d) A small cage

Q3. How long did Meera wait before the first sparrow arrived? (1 mark)

(a) Three days
(b) One week
(c) Three weeks
(d) One month

Q4. What did the society's garden committee do? (1 mark)

(a) It banned bird feeders
(b) It planted a row of trees

(c) It left one corner of the grounds wild

(d) It built a pond for birds

Q5. How many sparrows did the local bird group count in the society that spring? (1 mark)

(a) Six

(b) Twenty-three

(c) Forty

(d) Forty-one

Every June, when the first monsoon clouds gathered, the students of Green Valley School watched the rain run off the school roof and disappear down the drains. 'We catch nothing,' said Arif, a Class IX student, during an environmental studies period, 'and by February our taps are dry.' The remark became a project. With their teacher's help, the students measured the roof of the main block and calculated that a single heavy shower could fill three large tanks. They drew plans, priced the pipes and filters, and presented the proposal to the school management, which agreed to pay for the materials if the students did the planning and kept the records. By October, the system was ready. Rain from the roof now passes through a simple leaf filter into two storage tanks. The water is used for the school garden and for flushing, and a painted gauge on the tank wall shows everyone how much has been saved. In its first year, the project collected enough water to keep the garden green through the dry months, and the school's water bill fell by nearly a fifth. The students' record book, with its neat columns of rainfall and tank levels, is now the first thing visitors are shown.

Q6. What problem did Arif point out in his environmental studies period? (3 marks)

Q7. On what condition did the school management agree to pay for the materials? (3 marks)

Q8. Through what does the roof water pass before it reaches the tanks, and what two uses is the stored water put to? (3 marks)

Q9. State any two results of the project in its first year. (3 marks)

Q10. Which two details did the students record in their record book? (3 marks)

Section B – Writing (20 marks)

Attempt all questions. Internal choices are given where marked. Keep to the word limits stated.

Q11. You are the Secretary of the Cultural Society of your school. Your school is holding an inter-house painting competition next month. Write a notice, in about 50 words, informing the students of Classes IX to XII about the competition. Give the date, the venue, and how names are to be registered. (5 marks)

Word limit: about 50 words.

OR

You took part in a tree-plantation drive in your neighbourhood last weekend. Write a diary entry, in about 120 words, recording how the day went and how you felt at the end of it. (5 marks)

Word limit: about 120 words.

Q12. Write a letter to the Editor of a local newspaper, in about 120 words, drawing attention to the poor condition of the public park in your area and suggesting two improvements that the authorities could make. (5 marks)

Word limit: about 120 words.

OR

Write a letter to the manager of a sports-goods shop, in about 120 words, complaining about a cricket bat that you bought from the shop last month and that cracked within a week of use. Ask for a replacement or a refund. (5 marks)

Word limit: about 120 words.

Q13. Write a paragraph, in about 150 words, on the topic: A hobby can teach you things that a classroom cannot. (5 marks)

Word limit: about 150 words.

Q14. Write a short story, in about 150 words, beginning with the line: The old lighthouse keeper climbed the stairs for the last time. (5 marks)

Word limit: about 150 words.

OR

Write a descriptive paragraph, in about 150 words, describing a railway station early in the morning.(5 marks)

Word limit: about 150 words.

Section C – Literature and Language Study (40 marks)

Q15 to Q24 are objective questions on grammar and usage. The poem and the prose extract are printed with the questions based on them.

Q15. Choose the correctly reported form of: Ravi said, 'I am busy today.' (1 mark)

(a) Ravi said that he is busy today.

(b) Ravi said that he was busy that day.

(c) Ravi said that I was busy that day.

(d) Ravi says that he was busy today.

Q16. Fill in the blank: Neither the teacher nor the students ___ present in the hall. (1 mark)

(a) was

(b) were

(c) is

(d) has

Q17. Fill in the blank: She has been learning the violin ___ 2019. (1 mark)

(a) for

(b) from

(c) since

(d) by

Q18. Choose the correct passive form of: The gardener waters the plants every morning. (1 mark)

(a) The plants are watered by the gardener every morning.

(b) The plants were watered by the gardener every morning.

(c) The plants is watered by the gardener every morning.

(d) The plants have watered by the gardener every morning.

Q19. Fill in the blank: If it rains tomorrow, we ___ the match. (1 mark)

(a) would postpone

(b) will postpone

(c) postponed

(d) would have postponed

Q20. Choose the grammatically correct sentence. (1 mark)

(a) He is one of the best player in the team.

(b) He is one of the best players in the team.

(c) He is one of best player in the team.

(d) He is one of the best players in team.

Q21. Fill in the blank: The news ___ very encouraging. (1 mark)

(a) are

(b) were

(c) is

(d) have

Q22. Fill in the blank: You ___ submit the form before Friday; the office closes admissions after that. (1 mark)

(a) might

(b) must

(c) could

(d) would

Q23. Choose the correctly punctuated sentence. (1 mark)

(a) Its a beautiful day, isn't it?

(b) It's a beautiful day isn't it?

(c) It's a beautiful day, isn't it?

(d) Its a beautiful day isn't it.

Q24. Fill in the blank: Hardly had we sat down ___ the bell rang. (1 mark)

(a) than

(b) when

(c) then

(d) that

The River in October

After the rains, the river slows,
And learns the names of stones again;
It carries leaves, a broken oar,
The sky's last light, the smell of rain.
The heron stands where shallows gleam,
One leg, one shadow, perfectly still;
And all the noise of summer seems
To settle softly on the hill.

Q25. What does the river 'learn' again after the rains, and what does the phrase suggest? (3 marks)

Q26. Name any three things that the river carries in the poem. (3 marks)

Q27. What picture of the heron does the poet create? (3 marks)

Mr Elias had mended clocks in the same small shop for forty years. His hands, once steady enough to hold a screw the size of a grain of rice, now trembled slightly, but his ears had grown sharper with age. 'A clock tells you what is wrong with it,' he would say, 'if you have the patience to listen.' Young Thomas, who came after school to sweep the floor and watch, did not understand this at first. He wanted to open every clock at once. Slowly, though, he learnt to sit still, to wind, to wait, and to hear the small uneven heartbeat inside the brass case. On the day Mr Elias retired, he gave Thomas his own magnifying glass. 'The tools are nothing,' he said. 'The listening is everything.'

Q28. For how long had Mr Elias worked in the shop, and what change had age brought to his hands and to his ears? (3 marks)

Q29. What did Thomas want to do at first, and what did he slowly learn to do? (3 marks)

Q30. What did Mr Elias give Thomas on the day he retired, and what did his parting words mean? (3 marks)

Q31. Thomas changes from an impatient boy into a careful listener. Describe this change, and say what the extract suggests about how a craft is really learnt. Answer in about 120 words. (6 marks)

Word limit: about 120 words.

Q32. The extract ends with the words, 'The listening is everything.' Explain what 'listening' means here, with examples from the extract. Answer in about 120 words. (6 marks)
Word limit: about 120 words.

OR

Write a character sketch of Mr Elias in about 120 words, bringing out his skill, his patience, and his attitude towards his work. (6 marks)
Word limit: about 120 words.